

the bat and swing it or the tennis racket and swing it.” The interviewer teased him, saying that the Wii already does that.

“No, that’s not it. You can’t pick up your tennis racket. And swing it,” Gates retorted. “You can’t sit there with your friends and do those natural things. That’s a 3D positional device. This is video recognition.”

Cut to two years later and at the E3 game developers’ conference, Microsoft unveiled its foray into the motion-gaming world – the 3D body-tracking Project Natal.

With this new technology, MS had brought in a few stereoscopic cameras to do away with the controller itself! That’s right, Project Natal can be operated completely by using gestures of your hands or any object, without the need to even touch the controller.

In 2008, Microsoft had bought out an Israeli firm named 3DV systems, that specialised in motion-tracking cameras. Their technology has often been cited to be the backbone of the Natal system, which uses a sensor bar akin to the Nintendo Wii’s.

The Project Natal sensor is an approximately 9-inch wide horizontal bar, that is designed to be positioned lengthwise above or below the video



Microsoft’s 3D body-tracking Project Natal system for the Xbox 360 promises to revolutionise gaming, and possibly computing too

